

A2-B1 · MAYA & EMMA ENGLISH

Where Does Your Money Go? 5 Easy Ways to Save

Is your wallet empty before the end of the month? Maya and Emma share five easy ways to save a little money every day, plus a speaking practice and a quick quiz.

Words in this episode

wallet	a small case for your money and cards	*I keep my wallet in my bag.*
save	to keep money and not use it now	*I save a little money every month.*
discount	a lower price than usual	*This shop has a big discount today.*
spend	to use money to buy things	*I spend too much money on coffee.*
cheap	not costing a lot of money	*These shoes are cheap but good.*
receipt	a piece of paper that shows what you paid	*Please keep the receipt.*
waste	to use something badly, or to throw it away	*Please don't waste food.*
expensive	costing a lot of money	*This phone is too expensive for me.*
afford	to have enough money to buy something	*I can't afford a new car.*

bill	a paper that shows how much you must pay	*I pay my phone bill every month.*
goal	something that you want to do or to have in the future	*My goal is to visit Japan.*
budget	a plan for how you will use your money	*We have a small budget for the trip.*

Say it out loud

1. I save a little money every month.
2. I spend too much money on coffee.
3. This phone is too expensive for me.
4. I can't afford a new car.
5. We have a small budget for the trip.
6. And now, the quiz. I will give you a meaning. You say the word. Then Maya will tell you the answer. Let's go. Question one. Which word means, a lower price than usual?
7. Question two. Which word means, a piece of paper that shows what you paid?
8. Question three. Which word means, to have enough money to buy something?
9. And question four. Which word means, a plan for how you will use your money?

Transcript

Welcome

Emma: Hello everyone, and welcome back to our podcast! I'm Emma. This is the place where you can learn English with slow and clear conversations. Today we will talk about something that we all use every day. Money. Do you sometimes look at your wallet and think, where did my money go?

Maya: Hi Emma, and hi everyone! I'm Maya. Oh, I ask that question every month. On the first day of the month, I feel rich. On day twenty, I eat noodles.

Emma: Don't worry, Maya. Today we will share five easy ways to save a little money every day. You don't need a big salary, and you don't need to stop having fun. We also have a speaking practice and a quick quiz at the end.

Maya: Please stay with us until the end, everyone. Okay, Emma. I'm ready. But first, can we order two coffees and a cake?

Emma: Maya! We have coffee in the kitchen. That is lesson zero.

Maya's empty wallet

Emma: Maya, before the five ways, tell us a story. What happened to your money last month?

Maya: Oh, it is a sad story. Last week I cleaned my wardrobe. You remember my wardrobe. And inside, I found a lot of things that I bought and never used.

Emma: What did you find?

Maya: Three umbrellas. A yoga mat, and I don't do yoga. A lamp that looks like a fish. And four T-shirts with the price still on them.

Emma: Four new T-shirts! Why did you buy them?

Maya: Because of the discount. The sign said, buy three and get one free. I only needed one T-shirt. But I thought, wow, a free T-shirt! So I paid for three.

Emma: So you didn't save money. You spent three times more.

Maya: Yes. When I counted everything in the wardrobe, I felt a little sick. That was a lot of money, and it was just sleeping there in the dark.

Where does the money go?

Maya: Emma, why does this happen? I'm not a rich cat. I don't buy cars or gold. But my money still goes away.

Emma: That is the interesting part, Maya. Most people don't lose their money on big things. They lose it on small things. A coffee here, a snack there, a taxi when you are late.

Maya: But a coffee is cheap. It is only a few dollars.

Emma: Yes, one coffee is cheap. But one coffee every day is thirty coffees a month. Small numbers are quiet, so we don't see them. But together they are big.

Maya: Hmm. And there is another problem. Now it is so easy to pay. I just touch my phone, and it says, beep. I don't see the money, so I don't feel it.

Emma: Exactly. When you pay with paper money, you see your wallet get thin. When you pay with your phone, nothing changes. So your brain thinks, it is okay, I still have a lot.

Maya: So the problem is not one big mistake. The problem is many small things that I don't see.

Emma: That is the right way to think. And the good news is, when you start to see them, you can change them. Let's start with number one.

Way 1: Write it down

Emma: Way number one. Write down everything you spend. Do it for one week only.

Maya: Everything? Even a bottle of water?

Emma: Even a bottle of water. You can use a small notebook, or the notes on your phone. Just write the thing and the price. Coffee, three dollars. Bus, two dollars.

Maya: That sounds like a lot of work.

Emma: It takes ten seconds each time. And here is a small trick. Keep every receipt in one pocket. In the evening, take them out and write the numbers down.

Maya: And what do I do at the end of the week?

Emma: You add everything, and you look at the list. I promise, you will have a surprise. When I did this the first time, I found that I spent more on snacks than on books.

Maya: Oh no. I am afraid to see my number for bubble tea.

Emma: Don't be afraid. It is not a test, and nobody will be angry with you. You only want to know the truth. You can't fix a problem when you can't see it.

Way 2: Go shopping with a list

Maya: Okay, I think I know the next one. My grandmother always did this. Way number two. Go shopping with a list.

Emma: Yes! Tell us how your grandmother did it.

Maya: Before she went to the market, she looked in the kitchen. What do we have? What do we need? Then she wrote a short list. Rice, eggs, tomatoes, soap. And in the market, she bought only those things.

Emma: That is very clever. Supermarkets are made to sell you more. The sweet things are next to the door. The chocolate is next to the place where you pay.

Maya: And I always go shopping when I am hungry. That is a big mistake. When I am hungry, everything looks delicious. I go in for milk, and I come out with two bags.

Emma: So here are two small rules. One, eat something before you go. Two, when you see a thing that is not on your list, ask yourself, do I need it, or do I only want it?

Maya: Need or want. That is a good question. I need rice. I want a lamp that looks like a fish.

Emma: Ha! And the list helps you with one more thing. You don't waste food. You buy what you will really eat, so nothing goes bad in the fridge.

Way 3: Wait one day

Emma: Way number three is my favourite. Wait one day before you buy something you want.

Maya: Wait one day? But what if the thing is gone tomorrow?

Emma: Then it is gone, and your life is still fine. Here is the rule. If you see something nice and it is not food or something you really need, don't buy it now. Go home. Sleep. Come back tomorrow.

Maya: Why does it help?

Emma: Because the feeling of, I want it now, is very strong, but it is very short. After one night, you can think more clearly. Many times you wake up and you think, I don't really need that.

Maya: That is true. I wanted the fish lamp so much in the shop. And at home, I looked at it and thought, why?

Emma: And for an expensive thing, like a new phone or a bicycle, wait longer. Wait one week, or even one month.

Maya: What about shopping on my phone? At night, I lie in bed and I look at shoes.

Emma: It is the same rule. Put the shoes in the basket, and then close the app. If you still want them the next evening, and you can afford them, then you can buy them.

Maya: Okay. The basket can wait. I like this one, because I don't have to say no. I only say, not today.

Way 4: Cook at home

Maya: Way number four. Cook at home more often, and bring your own lunch.

Emma: Yes. Food is a big part of the money we spend. How often do you eat out, Maya?

Maya: Hmm. Lunch, every work day. And dinner, maybe three times a week. And the coffee, of course.

Emma: Let's do some easy math. A lunch outside costs about eight dollars. A lunch from home costs about three dollars. So you save five dollars every day.

Maya: Five dollars is not so much.

Emma: Five dollars a day is twenty five dollars a week. That is about one hundred dollars a month, only from lunch.

Maya: One hundred dollars! Okay, now I am listening. But I am not a good cook, Emma. I can make eggs, and I can make noodles.

Emma: That is enough to start. Cook one big pot of something on Sunday. Rice and vegetables, or a soup. Put it in small boxes, and you have lunch for three days.

Maya: And I can make my coffee at home, and bring it in a bottle.

Emma: Good idea. But please remember, you don't have to stop everything. Eating out with friends is a happy thing. Just do it one time less each week. Small changes are easier to keep.

Way 5: Save first

Emma: And way number five. Save first, and spend after. Most people do the opposite.

Maya: What do you mean?

Emma: Most people get their money, they pay their bills, they spend all month, and they hope to save what is left at the end. But at the end, there is usually nothing left.

Maya: That is my life. At the end of the month, only noodles are left.

Emma: So change the order. On the day you get your money, put a small part away first. Put it in a different place, so you can't see it. Then you live on the rest.

Maya: How much do I put away?

Emma: Start small. Really small. Even five dollars a week is a good start. The number is not important at the beginning. The habit is important.

Maya: And I think it helps to have a goal. Money for nothing is boring. But money for a trip to the sea, that is exciting.

Emma: Yes! Give your money a name. Write it on a piece of paper. For my trip. For my new laptop. For a rainy day. Then, when you want to buy a fish lamp, you can ask, lamp or sea?

Maya: Sea! Always the sea.

Three common mistakes

Emma: Now, let's talk about three common mistakes. Mistake number one. Thinking that a discount always saves you money.

Maya: Oh, that is me and my four T-shirts. If I don't need the thing, a discount is not a gift. I still spend money.

Emma: Right. Fifty percent off a thing you don't need is still one hundred percent wasted. Ask the same question every time. Was it on my list?

Maya: Mistake number two. Making a plan that is too hard. One month I said, I will spend nothing on fun. No coffee, no films, no friends. After five days I was so sad that I bought a very big cake.

Emma: Yes. A budget is not a prison. A good budget has a small part for fun, too. When your plan is kind, you can keep it for a long time.

Maya: And mistake number three. Looking at other people. My friend has a new phone, so I want a new phone. My neighbour goes to an expensive restaurant, so I want to go too.

Emma: That is very important, Maya. You don't know their story, and you don't know their bills. Look at your own goal, and walk on your own road.

Your plan for this week

Emma: Okay, Maya. Let's make a small plan for this week, and I want our listeners to make one too. What will you do first?

Maya: First, I will write down everything I spend for seven days. Even the bubble tea. I am ready for the truth.

Emma: Good. And then?

Maya: Then I will cook a big pot of soup on Sunday and bring my lunch three times. And when I see something nice in a shop, I will say, not today, and wait one day.

Emma: And your goal?

Maya: My goal is a trip to the sea next summer. I will put five dollars a week in a small box. I will write on the box, sea.

Emma: That is a lovely plan. It is small, it is clear, and it has a happy goal. Now, dear listeners, it's your turn. What is one small thing that you buy too often? And what is your goal? Think about it for a moment.

Your turn: speaking practice

Maya: Okay, everyone. Now it's your turn to speak. Emma will say a sentence with one of today's words. After that, there is a short quiet time. Please say the sentence out loud. Are you ready? Here is sentence number one.

Emma: I save a little money every month.

Maya: Very good. Here is sentence number two.

Emma: I spend too much money on coffee.

Maya: Nice. Here is sentence number three.

Emma: This phone is too expensive for me.

Maya: Great job. Here is sentence number four.

Emma: I can't afford a new car.

Maya: And here is the last one. Sentence number five.

Emma: We have a small budget for the trip.

Maya: Well done! You just used five words from this episode. Say them again tonight, before you sleep.

Quick quiz

Emma: And now, the quiz. I will give you a meaning. You say the word. Then Maya will tell you the answer. Let's go. Question one. Which word means, a lower price than usual?

Maya: The answer is, discount. This shop has a big discount today.

Emma: Question two. Which word means, a piece of paper that shows what you paid?

Maya: The answer is, receipt. Please keep the receipt.

Emma: Question three. Which word means, to have enough money to buy something?

Maya: The answer is, afford. I can't afford a new car.

Emma: And question four. Which word means, a plan for how you will use your money?

Maya: The answer is, budget. And a good budget has a small part for cake!

Emma: How many answers did you know? If you knew two or more, that is a great start. Listen to this episode again tomorrow, and try the quiz one more time.

Review and goodbye

Maya: Let's quickly review our five ways. Way one. Write down everything you spend for one week. Way two. Go shopping with a list, and not when you are hungry. Way three. Wait one day before you buy something you want.

Emma: Way four. Cook at home more often, and bring your own lunch. And way five. Save first, and spend after. Give your money a name and a goal.

Maya: And remember, a discount is not a gift when you don't need the thing. I learned that from four T-shirts. By the way, does anyone want a lamp that looks like a fish? It is almost new.

Emma: Oh, Maya! We have a small job for you today, everyone. Tell us in the comments. What is one thing that you want to save money for? We would love to read your answers.

Maya: If this episode helped you, please like the video and subscribe to our channel. And share it with a friend who always says, I have no money this month.

Emma: Thank you for listening, everyone. Save a little today, and have a wonderful day. See you in the next episode!

Maya: Bye, everyone. I'm going home to make my own coffee!
